KAZI WALEED AHMED

view Portfolio

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Multidisciplinary creative with **8+ years** in network agencies and production studios leading cross-functional teams across digital, brand strategy, and integrated campaigns for Fortune 500 portfolios across the GCC and MENAP. Creatively directs brand comms lifting brand affinity by **18%** and category share by **20%** while maintaining a **60%** pitch conversion rate. Combines consumer insight with compelling storytelling and **AI-workflows** to drive results and mentor incredible teams.

EXPERIENCE

Regional Creative Lead | *Helium Marketing - MENA* — ***UAE • 2025 – present***

- Spearheading brand strategy, creative direction and content production for a **$16M** portfolio (PepsiCo, Unilever, Barbican and more) across **6** GCC markets, delivering **40+** integrated brand activations and campaigns annually.
- Developed the winning 'Raise The Game' strategy to pivot Barbican toward evening social occasions for the AFC Champions League partnership. Executed the **$700K+** GCC-wide campaign across **4** markets, spanning stadium, retail, digital, and a consumer promotion microsite.
- Run 4 live pitches a month at a **60% win-rate** against Omnicom, Publicis and local agencies while managing a cross-functional team of strategists, creatives, designers, animators. Won Dubai Holding's corporate creative business from their aligned network agency in our **first** pitch.
- Instituted and mentor a **'think tank'** team of bright creatives, originating proactive concepts for seasons, launches and cultural moments, generating **2-3** large-scale pitches a month at **~30% conversion** in our first year.
- Designed and executed a **10x10m** activation for Sting at MDLBEAST Riyadh 2025, driving **14K+** samplings, **240K+** organic impressions, alongside Flamin' Hot's KSA culinary activation (3 cities) that earned an Outstanding Activation nomination at the Saudi Event Awards 2025.
- Led campaigns for DZRT's repositioning to 'Breathe Life' via content, digital activations, and experience platforms on-ground.
- Directed Close Up's 'White Now' 3D campaign (26 assets), using performance data to optimize real-time assets driving a **+32% retention lift**.
- Deliver Unilever Food Solutions content e2e: an **always-on** slate of recipe films, photography, social assets and creatives for brand partnerships.
- Art directed seasonal packaging across 5 PepsiCo snack ranges, **saving 24%** of production budget while upholding global design standards.

Creative Director | Adcom *Leo Burnett* — ***PK • 2024 – 2025***

- Led **2** of the market's **largest** portfolios – Procter & Gamble (MENAP) and Philip Morris – at Effie's 2025 Network Agency of the Year.
- Wrote ZYN's 2.0 campaign slate of **15** DVCs and directed **CGI** variant-launches, navigating strict regulatory guardrails on a tier-1 market budget, contributing to a **20% category share growth** against the legacy player.
- Developed the 'Shhh Nahi Shhhare' campaign for Always from a consumer insight on cultural silence around period discomfort, repositioning an improved product around confidence vs compromise, achieving **96% positive** brand perception **reversing** two years of **20%** market-share decline.
- Conceived and executed Safeguard's first brand repositioning in 20 years with 'Hifazat Ka Allrounder' campaign alongside Ariel's value-tier rollout during peak inflation, driving an **18%** brand affinity lift and protecting **78%** of baseline sales volume for Ariel.
- Associate-directed **5 DVCs** through post, presented to global brand teams and market stakeholders, and integrated AI tools into team workflows to accelerate output while preserving human craft and insight.

Associate Creative Director | *MullenLowe* — ***PK • 2021 – 2024***

- **Portfolio:** Unilever, Dalda Foods, KIA Motors, EFU Life, Shangrila Foods, and TrueCoverage, across 2 global markets.
- Led and mentored a cross-functional team of **12** across **11** brand accounts over my tenure, running creative ideation, review, and feedback while reporting directly to the CCO, and introduced **agency-wide** AI workflows across copy, design and video.
- Modernized legacy FMCG brands for younger demographics, driving **11%** sales increase and an Effie Gold for Dalda by engaging millennial consumers, and reworked Knorr's bouillon brand identity for Gen-Z through thematic TVCs and strategic creator partnerships.
- Secured **2** new brands and won back **2** departing ones through pitches I led, expanding my team by **4** and growing the agency retainer base by **20%**.
- Repositioned KIA Stonic against the category's two best-selling sedans through an award-winning **multi-series** DVC campaign.
- Created the brand identity, strategy, and **360°** omnichannel launch campaign for EFU Life's WIN wellness app, **winning** Insurance Asia Award 2022.

Creative Producer | *SEEME Productions , Tall Man Films , Digital Invasion Films* — ***UAE & PK • 2018 – 2021***

- Produced, wrote and directed branded content and entertainment properties for clients including EBM, National Foods, Domino's, Oppo and Bayer, owning budgets, production, post-production, photography, and sponsorships, collaborating with global directors and crew.
- Produced **16+** TVCs, an Effie-winning 12-episode web series, and **directed all BTS** content across the films and DVC projects.
- Stood up a new **OTT** and **cinema content division** end to end, delivering **2** theatrical feature films and pre-producing **1** web series for OTT.
- Created 'Digestive Showtime', a **5-film** content platform for YouTube with **15M+** views in our 1st month, coordinating **5** directors and crews of **150**.

SKILLS

Concept development and campaign platforms · art direction, visual craft · creative brief development · consumer insight · copywriting · team leadership, mentoring and creative review · new business pitching and proposal development · presenting to senior clients · AI production workflows · packaging design · end-to-end DVC/film production · category and consumer analysis · experience and activation design · DVC/ film direction

Tools: Claude, Office 365, Final Cut Pro, Adobe CC, Higgsfield, Keynote, Google Flow, Monday | **Languages:** English, Urdu, Arabic (learning)

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

Outstanding Activation Nominee, Saudi Event Awards — Flamin' Hot Culinary Activation	@ Helium MENA	**2025**
Best Social Good Brand, Dragons of Asia — Always – 'Changing the Narrative'	@ Adcom Leo Burnett	**2025**
Sustainability & Environment, Dragons of Asia — Ariel – 'Sustainability at Home'	@ Adcom Leo Burnett	**2024**
Effie Award, Gold — Dalda Foods 'Jahan Maamta Wahan Dalda'	@ MullenLowe	**2023**
Effie Award, Bronze — Tullo 'Restaging the Kids'	@ MullenLowe	**2023**
iF Design Award — KIA Stonic "#PlayItYoung"	@ MullenLowe	**2023**
Effie Award, Bronze — 'National Ketchup Factory' Web Series (12 Episodes)	@ Digital Invasion	**2020**

EDUCATION

- Bachelor of Media Science, Film & TV — Iqra University | Dean's Honor List 2018 — **CGPA 3.8**
- Bachelor Studies, Computer Science — Ghulam Ishaq Khan Institute | 2014 - 2016